

BHUPINDER GIRI

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Between mortal humanity and the great beyond, there exists another layer in the hierarchy of beings: the sadhus. And of the holy legion whose very sight strikes awe and wonder among the devout, none's more regal in bearing than this 6'5" friar of the Niranjani Akhara. Originally a Sikh, regular schooling showing in his basic English politesse, he took sanyas in 1989, and was a Naga monk by 1998. On these crystal waters, his *baghambar* (tiger skin-clad) self hovers like an apparition sculpted out of myth itself. He's used to being a star attraction: after all, this is the closest selfie-seekers get to sharing a frame with the likeness of Shiva himself!